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GOP asks if college is worth it
Seeks penalties for high debt, low-paying jobs

By Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

The conservatives who will influence education policy during the incoming Trump administration, long the principal driver of upward mobility in the United States, has become a poor investment for far too many students and is in need of sweeping reform.

They point to the large number of students who drop out of degree programs, as many as 40 percent, and those saddled with crippling debt or stuck in low-paying jobs despite holding expensive degrees.

But instead of directly trying to discourage college applicants, the ascendant conservative thought leaders want to penalize schools financially when their graduates are late on loan payments or their earnings don't justify the cost of tuition.

"There should be accountability on the colleges and universities, so that if the students succeed, they succeed, and if

COLLEGES, Page A14

In N.H., a diminished voice in the digital age

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

For decades, the New Hampshire Union Leader had a dual identity: the Granite State's newspaper of record and one of the nation's leading daily publications in Republican politics.

The paper's broad coverage of city government, business, and high school sports in the state's largest city, Manchester, and across New Hampshire was underwritten by a broad readership and a profitable advertising business. Its reach and thunderous editorial voice also gave the Union Leader's publishers enough influence to occasionally derail presidential hopefuls in the state's pivotal first-in-the-nation primary.

But the Golden Age for the paper appears to be over. The Union Leader's deeply diminished audience in the digital age

UNION LEADER, Page A8

About two dozen lawmakers — or roughly **one in eight** of all 200 — reported earning more than \$100,000 in addition to their legislative pay.

The Beacon Hill side hustle

Lawmaking is a full-time gig; so is a second job for many legislators

By Emma Platoff and Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

The number two Democrat in the Massachusetts House worked as a consultant on the side — and didn't have to

name his clients on his financial disclosures. A Brockton state representative doubled as a city councilor while also owning a law firm and a realty business. A handful of legislators reported having as many

as three outside jobs; two told the Globe they work as many as 100 hours per week combined between their legislative job and another full-time position.

Massachusetts is one of just

10 states with a full-time Legislature, and the vast majority of Massachusetts legislators earn a six-figure salary. Yet at least 91 lawmakers in the 200-seat Legislature reported hav-

OUTSIDE PAY, Page A15

'THIS IS BIGGER THAN ME'

A trip to Florida offered a chance at redemption.

The Mattapan Patriots under-14 team played in the American Youth Football national tournament last year but were eliminated in early round play. This year needed to be different. They wanted to win it all — for themselves and for their teammates who were aging out and headed onto high school. But there is more than just gridiron glory on the line. They were here to represent Mattapan, which, despite its struggles over the decades, these teens proudly carried on their shoulders. **A16.**



PHOTOS BY ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

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And heaven and nature sting



Sunday: Numbingly cold.
High 19-24, low 11-16.
Monday: Slightly warmer.
High 25-30, low 21-26
Complete report, **A24.**
Obituaries, **A23.**



Rickey Henderson has died.
Dubbed "The Man of Steal," the dynamic outfielder rewrote the record books in several categories, including stolen bases, before finishing his career with the Red Sox and Los Angeles Dodgers. He was 65. **Obituary, A22, appreciation C3.**

Want to move to your favorite vacation locale? Get ready for pleasures and more than a few pitfalls. **Address, H.**

The bruising political battle over the federal budget was a sobering warning for President-elect Donald Trump. **A2.**

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